# Susan A. Berube-Leiva

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## EDUCATION

**Kean University** Union, NJ — *Expected May 2027*
Bachelor of Arts in English Literature and Communication – Journalism — *(GPA: 3.86/4.0)*
**Campus Involvement:** McNair Scholarship Program, Leadership Institute, *The Tower*

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**House of Hearts Network;** Elizabeth, NJ — *May 2026 – Present*
*Chief of Staff, Office of the President*
- Direct internal and external communications strategies to strengthen organizational visibility and stakeholder engagement.
- Develop and implement outreach initiatives that expand community partnerships and increase participation in organizational programs such as a webinar series and 4 community impact funds.
- Oversee the Women's Health and Leadership fund as co-chair and collaborate with fund members to plan initiatives and fundraise for events such as Women's Day Brunch.

**Kean University,** — *December 2023 - Present*
**Division of General Education and Interdisciplinary Studies;** Union, NJ
*General Education Mentor (Student Assistant)*
- Co-facilitating with 4 professors each semester in the Transition to Kean course, consisting of 25 students each, to introduce and advise students on Kean's offered resources.
- Managing data collection of 500-1000 students' testing scores and their course placements, then following the students through the end of the corresponding semester to analyze successes and progression.
- Offer efficient customer service to professors and students via various forms of communication in the office.

**The Lesniak Institute for American Leadership;** Union, NJ — *September 2025 – May 2026*
*Service Specialist Intern*
- Supporting the Executive Director in planning and managing community engagement initiatives, contributing to outreach efforts that have connected with over 30 local families and non-profit organizations.
- Designing and executing large-scale events, recruiting volunteers and attendees through multiple outreach channels while maintaining detailed records of community partners and stakeholders.
- Drafting and editing institutional documents and a published blog post, enhancing the Institute's digital presence.

## LEADERSHIP AND HONORS

- **Alternate Student Trustee, Board of Trustees:** Advocating for the student body as a non-voting member on the Board of Trustees at Kean University through collaboration with the trustees, university president, and the voting student trustee to ensure the student population is served well by its institution.
- **President's Advisory Council, Co-Chair:** Lead meetings with other members and the university president to address student concerns, plan and host events for the student body, as well as share student experiences and perspectives.
- **Center for Undergraduate Research and Fellowship, Student Researcher:** Collaborating with a professor and peer student researcher to discover the gaps in reported news across Elizabeth, Roselle, and Union, and bridge these gaps through our work in the New Jersey News Accountability Project.
- **Awards:** Dean's List, Student Excellence Award ('23), Outstanding Kean Student Human Rights Activist Award ('26), Presidential Excellence Award in Student Leadership ('26)